

PRODUCT Requirement Document

Plateup (AI meal planner)

Executive Summary

PlateUp is an AI-powered meal planning platform built specifically for Nigerian households. The platform helps users generate personalized weekly meal plans based on their available budget, existing ingredients, household size, and dietary preferences.

Users simply enter how much they intend to spend on food for the week and the ingredients they already have at home. PlateUp then generates a complete 7-day meal plan covering breakfast, lunch, and dinner, alongside a shopping list containing any additional ingredients required.

Unlike existing meal-planning solutions that primarily focus on Western diets and international markets, PlateUp is designed with Nigerian users in mind. The platform prioritizes Nigerian meals, Naira-based budgeting, and practical meal recommendations that align with local cooking habits and ingredient availability.

Value Proposition

PlateUp helps users:

- Reduce meal-planning stress.
- Stay within food budgets.
- Reduce food waste.
- Save time spent deciding what to cook.
- Generate shopping lists automatically.
- Save and reuse successful meal plans.

Problem Statement

Meal planning is a recurring challenge for millions of Nigerians.

Every day, individuals and families spend significant time deciding what meals to prepare while balancing household budgets, ingredient availability, nutritional needs, and personal preferences.

As food prices continue to rise and household budgets become increasingly constrained, effective meal planning has become more important than ever.

Unfortunately, most Nigerians still rely on manual planning methods, family recommendations, memory, or generic internet searches when deciding what to cook.

1. Decision Fatigue

Many Nigerians struggle with deciding what meals to prepare each day. Questions such as “What should we cook?”, “What ingredients do we already have?”, and “Can we stay within budget?” create recurring stress and consume valuable time.

Without a structured planning system, meal decisions become repetitive and mentally exhausting.

2. Food Waste

Many households purchase groceries without a clear meal plan. As a result, ingredients are often forgotten, expire before use, or are discarded unnecessarily.

Poor planning leads to wasted food and avoidable household expenses.

3. Budget Constraints

Rising food prices and inflation have increased pressure on household budgets. Many Nigerians struggle to balance meal variety, nutritional needs, and affordability.

Without planning tools, it becomes difficult to control food spending and avoid unnecessary purchases.

4. Lack of Nigerian-Focused Solutions

Most meal-planning applications were designed for international audiences.

These platforms frequently:

- Recommend unfamiliar meals.
- Assume access to foreign ingredients.
- Ignore Nigerian food culture.
- Focus on currencies other than Naira.

As a result, many Nigerians find existing solutions impractical.

5. Lack of Meal History and Reusability

Many meal-planning approaches are temporary.

Users often discover useful meal plans but have no convenient way to:

- Save them.
- Organize them.
- Reuse them later.

This forces users to repeatedly solve the same meal-planning problems.

Product Vision & Goals

To become the AI meal planning assistant built specifically for Nigerian households.

Mission Statement

To help Nigerians plan affordable, practical, and personalized meals while reducing food waste and simplifying household food decisions.

Product Goals

- Simplify Meal Planning
- Reduce the time and effort users spend deciding what to cook.
- Reduce Food Waste
- Encourage users to maximize ingredients they already own before purchasing additional items.
- Support Budget Management
- Help households remain within food budgets while maintaining meal variety.
- Promote Nigerian Cuisine
- Provide meal recommendations that align with Nigerian food culture and cooking habits.
- Create Reusable Meal Planning Workflows
- Allow users to save, revisit, and reuse successful meal plans.

Target Users & Personas

Primary Target Users

Nigerian Households

Families responsible for planning meals for multiple people.

Needs:

- Weekly meal planning.
- Budget management.
- Efficient grocery shopping.

Pain Points:

- Rising food costs.
- Meal-planning stress.
- Food waste.

Working Professionals

Busy individuals with limited time for meal planning.

Needs:

- Quick planning.
- Reduced decision-making.
- Efficient shopping.

Pain Points:

- Long work hours.

- Dependence on takeout.
- Lack of planning time.

Students

Students living independently or on limited budgets.

Needs:

- Affordable meals.
- Efficient use of ingredients.
- Practical meal suggestions.

Pain Points:

- Limited funds.
- Limited cooking experience.
- Repetitive meal choices.

Health-Conscious Individuals

Users seeking more structured meal-planning habits.

Needs:

- Consistency.
- Better food choices.
- Meal organization.

Pain Points:

- Inconsistent eating habits.

- Lack of planning structure.

Personas

Chidinma – **Working Professional**

Age: 28

Occupation: Accountant

Location: Lagos

Profile

Chidinma works long hours and often struggles to decide what to cook after work. Because she has limited time for meal planning, she frequently relies on takeout and spends more on food than intended.

Primary Goal

Save time and stay within her food budget.

Biggest Pain Point

Lack of meal-planning time during busy work weeks.

Current Alternative

YouTube, ChatGPT, and family recommendations.

Mrs. Adeyemi – **Family Planner**

Age: 42

Occupation: Business Owner

Profile

Mrs. Adeyemi is responsible for planning meals for a family of five. She wants to reduce food waste while ensuring her household stays within budget.

Primary Goal

Plan affordable meals for her family.

Biggest Pain Point

Managing weekly meal planning and grocery shopping.

Current Alternative

Manual planning, family discussions, and WhatsApp recommendations.

Emeka – **University Student**

Age: 21

Occupation: Undergraduate Student

Profile

Emeka lives on a limited monthly allowance and wants affordable meal options that help him avoid unnecessary spending.

Primary Goal

Make his food budget last longer.

Biggest Pain Point

Limited funds and repetitive meal choices.

Current Alternative

Instant noodles and simple repeated meals.

Key Use Cases

Use Case 1 – Weekly Family Meal Planning

Mrs. Adeyemi is a business owner and mother of three who manages meal planning for her household every week. With rising food prices and varying family preferences, deciding what to cook has become increasingly stressful. She wants to provide balanced meals for her family while staying within a fixed grocery budget.

At the beginning of the week, she opens PlateUp and enters her weekly food budget of ₦40,000, the ingredients already available in her kitchen, and her household size.

PlateUp analyzes the information and generates a complete 7-day meal plan containing breakfast, lunch, and dinner recommendations for the entire family. The platform also creates a shopping list showing only the additional ingredients required.

By using PlateUp, Mrs. Adeyemi spends less time planning meals, reduces food waste, and maintains better control over household food expenses.

Use Case 2 – Student Budget Meal Planning

Emeka is a university student living away from home and relying on a limited monthly allowance. He often struggles to decide what meals he can afford and frequently falls back on repetitive options such as noodles because he lacks meal-planning ideas.

At the start of the week, Emeka enters his available budget of ₦10,000 along with ingredients already available in his hostel kitchen.

PlateUp generates a practical 7-day meal plan focused on affordability while maximizing the ingredients he already has. The platform suggests simple Nigerian meals that fit within his budget constraints and provides a shopping list for any missing items.

As a result, Emeka spends less money on food, enjoys more variety in his meals, and manages his allowance more effectively.

Use Case 3 – Ingredient Utilization and Food Waste Reduction

Chidinma is a busy accountant who often purchases groceries but struggles to use them before they spoil. At the end of each week, she frequently throws away unused ingredients because she has no structured meal plan.

One weekend, she opens PlateUp and enters the ingredients currently available in her kitchen, including rice, tomatoes, onions, vegetables, and beans. She also provides her weekly food budget.

Rather than recommending entirely new meals, PlateUp prioritizes recipes that make use of the ingredients she already owns. Additional purchases are minimized, and a shopping list is generated only when necessary.

This helps Chidinma reduce food waste, save money, and make better use of groceries that would otherwise go unused.

Use Case 4 – Reusing Successful Meal Plans

After using PlateUp for several weeks, Mrs. Adeyemi discovers a meal plan that works exceptionally well for her family. The meals are affordable, easy to prepare, and well received by everyone in the household.

Instead of creating a new plan from scratch, she navigates to Meal History and selects the previously saved meal plan.

PlateUp instantly restores the meal plan and shopping list, allowing her to reuse it without generating a new recommendation.

This saves time, reduces planning effort, and encourages long-term use of the platform by allowing users to build a personal library of successful meal plans.

Use Case 5 – Budget-Aware Meal Planning

Tunde is a young professional who wants to reduce unnecessary spending on food. Although he creates weekly food budgets, he often exceeds them because he lacks a structured plan for what to cook and what to buy.

Before grocery shopping, he enters his weekly food budget, available ingredients, and household size into PlateUp.

The platform generates meal recommendations designed to align with his budget and displays a budget status indicator showing whether the proposed meal plan falls within, near, or above his intended spending target.

With greater visibility into his food expenses, Tunde can make informed decisions before shopping and avoid unnecessary spending throughout the week.

Key Features (MVP)

The MVP focuses on solving the core meal-planning problem while maintaining a manageable development scope.

The objective is to deliver immediate value to users through a streamlined experience.

Authentication & Account Management

Authentication is a foundational feature of PlateUp.

Users must create accounts before accessing the platform.

Features Included

- User Registration
- Login
- Logout
- Email Verification
- Password Reset
- Protected Access

Why It Matters

Authentication enables:

- Meal plan saving
- Meal history
- User personalization
- Future account-based features

Onboarding

New users complete onboarding after account creation and verification.

The onboarding experience helps PlateUp understand user preferences and provide more relevant recommendations.

Information Collected

Step 1: Household Size

Users select the number of people they are planning meals for.

Options may include:

- 1 Person
- 2 People
- 3–4 People
- 5+ People

This information helps PlateUp generate meal plans that better reflect household needs.

Step 2: Primary Goal

Users select their primary meal-planning objective.

Options include:

- Save Money
- Save Time
- Reduce Food Waste
- Eat Healthier

Why It Matters

Better onboarding leads to more relevant meal recommendations.

Budget Input

Budget Estimation Strategy

Budget awareness is one of PlateUp's core differentiators. However, the MVP will not rely on real-time market pricing data.

Instead, PlateUp will use estimated ingredient cost ranges based on common Nigerian market prices. These estimates will be maintained internally and periodically updated to reflect general market conditions.

When generating meal plans, the AI will:

- Consider the user's weekly budget.
- Consider household size.
- Prioritize ingredients already available at home.
- Select meals that are generally affordable within the provided budget range.

- Minimize recommendations that would likely exceed the user's spending target.

Important Note

PlateUp should be positioned as a budgeting assistant rather than a real-time market pricing platform.

Budget recommendations are intended to help users make informed decisions, but actual ingredient costs may vary based on location, seasonality, inflation, and individual purchasing habits.

Future versions may introduce real-time market intelligence and retailer integrations to improve pricing accuracy.

Ingredient Input

Users provide ingredients currently available at home.

Why It Matters

Many households already possess ingredients that can be incorporated into future meals.

PlateUp uses this information to maximize ingredient utilization and reduce waste.

Expected Outcome

Users spend less on unnecessary ingredients.

AI Meal Generation

This is the core feature of PlateUp.

The AI uses:

- Budget
- Available ingredients
- Household size
- User preferences

to generate personalized meal plans.

Output Includes

- 7-day meal plan
- Breakfast suggestions
- Lunch suggestions
- Dinner suggestions

Why It Matters

The platform's primary value comes from simplifying meal-planning decisions.

Shopping List Generation

After generating a meal plan, PlateUp creates a shopping list containing ingredients that are not already available.

Why It Matters

Users can immediately act on generated meal plans.

Benefits

- Simplifies grocery shopping
- Improves planning efficiency
- Reduces forgotten purchases

Save Meal Plans

Users can save generated meal plans for future use.

Why It Matters

Useful plans should not disappear after generation.

Saving plans increases long-term value and retention.

Meal History

Meal History provides users with access to previously saved meal plans.

Information Displayed

- Date Generated
- Budget Used
- Meal Summary

Available Actions

- View
- Reuse
- Delete

Why It Matters

Meal History transforms one-time planning into a reusable planning system.

Reuse Meal Plans

Users can reuse previously saved plans without generating new ones.

Why It Matters

Many users will have meal plans that consistently work well for their households.

Reusing plans saves time and effort.

Delete Meal Plans

Users can remove meal plans from their history.

Why It Matters

Users should have control over their saved data.

Regenerate Meal Plans

Users can generate alternative meal suggestions if they are not satisfied with the initial output.

Why It Matters

Provides flexibility and improves user satisfaction.

Budget Status Indicator

The platform provides visual indicators showing whether meal plans remain aligned with user budgets.

Why It Matters

Helps users make informed decisions.

Example States

- Within Budget
- Near Budget Limit
- Above Budget

WhatsApp Sharing

Users can share meal plans and shopping lists through WhatsApp.

Why It Matters

WhatsApp is one of the most widely used communication platforms in Nigeria.

Sharing encourages collaboration and organic product discovery.

Future Features & Roadmap

The following features are intentionally excluded from the MVP but remain important opportunities for future development.

Personalized Recommendations

Future versions of PlateUp will learn from:

- Meal History
- Saved Plans
- User Preferences

to provide increasingly personalized meal suggestions.

Advanced Nutrition Insights

Future releases may provide:

- Calorie estimates
- Protein information
- Carbohydrate breakdowns
- Nutritional summaries

This feature is intentionally excluded from the MVP to maintain focus on core planning functionality.

Market Price Comparison

Future versions may compare ingredient prices across different markets and retailers.

This would allow users to make even more informed purchasing decisions.

Family Profiles

Future releases may support multiple users within a household.

Potential capabilities include:

- Shared meal planning
- Family preferences
- Collaborative planning

Meal Reminders

Future versions may notify users about upcoming meals and shopping needs.

Examples:

- Daily meal reminders
- Grocery reminders
- Weekly planning prompts

Mobile Applications

Following validation of the web platform, PlateUp may expand into:

- Android applications

- iOS applications

Premium Features

Future premium offerings may include:

- Unlimited meal generation
- Advanced nutrition insights
- Personalized recommendations
- Enhanced planning tools

These features are part of the long-term monetization strategy and remain outside the MVP scope.

Future Monetization Strategy

Monetization Philosophy

The primary objective of the PlateUp MVP is to validate product-market fit and build a loyal user base. During the MVP stage, the focus is on helping users generate, save, and reuse meal plans rather than generating revenue.

PlateUp follows a simple principle:

Deliver value first, monetize later.

Future Subscription Model

Following successful validation, PlateUp may adopt a freemium subscription model.

Free users will have access to core meal-planning functionality, while premium users may unlock additional capabilities such as:

- Unlimited meal plan generation
- Unlimited saved meal plans
- Personalized meal recommendations
- Advanced nutrition insights
- Meal reminders
- Enhanced planning tools

Subscription billing and payment processing are intentionally excluded from the MVP to maintain focus on validating the core product experience.

Additional Revenue Opportunities

Beyond subscriptions, PlateUp may explore:

- Grocery and retail partnerships
- Affiliate commissions on ingredient purchases
- Sponsored recommendations
- Premium family planning features

These opportunities will be evaluated after product-market fit has been established.

Detailed User Flows

The goal is to create a seamless experience that helps users quickly generate practical meal plans while reducing food-planning stress.

User Flow 1: Account Creation & Verification

Objective

Allow users to securely create an account and access PlateUp.

Flow Description

A new user visits the PlateUp website and selects the option to create an account.

The user enters their name, email address, and password. Once the registration form is submitted successfully, PlateUp sends a verification email to the provided email address.

The user opens the email and clicks the verification link. After verification is complete, the user can log in to the platform.

Outcome

The user successfully creates and verifies an account, gaining access to PlateUp.

User Flow 2: First-Time Onboarding

Objective

Collect information that improves meal recommendations.

Flow Description

Onboarding

New users complete a short onboarding process after account creation and email verification.

The onboarding experience is intentionally lightweight and designed to help users begin generating meal plans as quickly as possible.

Information Collected

Step 1: Household Size

Users select the number of people they are planning meals for.

Options may include:

- 1 Person
- 2 People
- 3–4 People
- 5+ People

This information helps PlateUp generate meal plans that better reflect household needs.

Step 2: Primary Goal

Users select their primary meal-planning objective.

Options include:

- Save Money
- Save Time
- Reduce Food Waste
- Eat Healthier

Outcome

The platform gathers user preferences and prepares a personalized experience.

User Flow 3: Meal Plan Generation

Objective

Generate a personalized weekly meal plan.

Flow Description

From the dashboard, the user enters their weekly food budget and lists the ingredients currently available at home.

After submitting the information, PlateUp processes the request and generates a complete seven-day meal plan.

The meal plan includes breakfast, lunch, and dinner recommendations for each day of the week. A shopping list is also generated containing ingredients that are not already available.

The generated plan is displayed on the screen for review.

Outcome

The user receives a practical and budget-aware meal plan tailored to their needs.

User Flow 4: Saving a Meal Plan

Objective

Allow users to keep useful meal plans for future use.

Flow Description

After reviewing a generated meal plan, the user can choose to save it.

Once saved, the meal plan becomes part of the user's Meal History and can be accessed at any time in the future.

Outcome

The meal plan is permanently stored in the user's account.

User Flow 5: Accessing Meal History

Objective

Allow users to view previously saved meal plans.

Flow Description

The user navigates to the Meal History section from the dashboard.

The Meal History page displays all previously saved meal plans, including information such as the date generated, budget used, and a brief meal summary.

The user can browse through historical meal plans and select any plan for further actions.

Outcome

Users can easily revisit previous meal-planning decisions.

User Flow 6: Reusing a Saved Meal Plan

Objective

Allow users to quickly reuse successful meal plans.

Flow Description

Within Meal History, the user selects a previously saved plan and chooses the reuse option.

The selected meal plan becomes active again and can be followed without generating a completely new plan.

Outcome

Users save time by reusing meal plans that have already proven useful.

User Flow 7: Deleting a Saved Meal Plan

Objective

Allow users to manage their Meal History.

Flow Description

The user selects a meal plan from Meal History and chooses the delete option.

A confirmation prompt appears asking the user to confirm the deletion.

Once confirmed, the meal plan is permanently removed from the account.

Outcome

Users maintain control over their saved meal plans.

User Flow 8: Regenerating a Meal Plan

Objective

Provide alternative recommendations when users are not satisfied with the generated output.

Flow Description

After reviewing a meal plan, the user may decide that they would like additional options.

The user selects the regenerate option, and PlateUp generates a new meal plan using the same inputs.

The newly generated plan replaces the previous recommendation on the screen.

Outcome

Users gain flexibility and increased satisfaction with meal recommendations.

User Flow 9: Sharing a Meal Plan

Objective

Allow users to share meal plans with family members and friends.

Flow Description

After generating or opening a meal plan, the user selects the share option.

The meal plan and shopping list can then be shared through WhatsApp.

This allows household members to review meals and coordinate grocery shopping more effectively.

Outcome

Meal planning becomes easier to coordinate among multiple people.

The PlateUp user journey is designed to be simple, intuitive, and focused on helping users quickly achieve their goal of generating practical meal plans.

Technical Requirements

PlateUp requires a modern, scalable, and maintainable technology stack capable of supporting AI-powered meal planning, user authentication, and persistent meal history.

The chosen stack prioritizes developer productivity, scalability, security, and deployment simplicity.

Frontend

Framework

Next.js 14 (App Router)

Backend

Next.js 14 (Server Actions + Route Handlers)

Language

TypeScript

PlateUp will follow a Server Actions-first backend architecture using Next.js App Router.

Server Actions will be the primary mechanism for handling business logic, database operations, authentication workflows, and AI meal-generation requests.

Typical request flow:

Frontend → Server Action → Validation → Business Logic → Database / DeepSeek API

Benefits

- Reduced boilerplate code
- Faster development and iteration
- Improved type safety
- Enhanced security through server-side execution
- Better integration with Next.js App Router

Route Handlers (API Routes) will be used only when necessary, including:

- Webhooks
- Third-party integrations
- External service callbacks

Expected architecture distribution:

- 80–90% Server Actions
- 10–20% Route Handlers
- Modern React architecture
- Strong performance
- Excellent developer experience
- Scalability

Database

Database System

PostgreSQL

Database Provider

Neon

Benefits

- Reliability
- Scalability
- Excellent integration with modern web applications

ORM

Prisma ORM

Benefits

- Type safety
- Database abstraction
- Improved developer productivity

Authentication

Auth.js

Features

- Login
- Registration
- Session management

- Route protection

Password Security

bcrypt

Purpose

Secure password hashing and storage.

Email Infrastructure

Primary Provider

Resend

Secondary Provider

Nodemailer

Use Cases

- Email verification
- Password reset
- Future transactional emails

Validation

Zod

Purpose

Ensure all user inputs are validated before processing.

Rate Limiting

Upstash

Purpose

Protect the platform against abuse and excessive requests.

AI Infrastructure

DeepSeek API

Responsibilities

- Meal generation
- Shopping list creation
- Personalized recommendations

Deployment

Vercel

Benefits

- Easy deployment
- Scalability
- Strong Next.js integration

Metrics of Success

MVP Success Targets

The PlateUp MVP will be considered successful if the following targets are achieved within the first 90 days after launch:

User Acquisition

- 500+ registered users
- 70% email verification rate
- 60% onboarding completion rate

Engagement

- 1,500+ meal plans generated
- 40% of users generate more than one meal plan
- 30% of users save at least one meal plan

Retention

- 25% of users reuse a saved meal plan
- 20% 30-day retention rate
- Average of 2 meal plan generations per active user per month

Product Quality

- Average meal generation time below 60 seconds
- 95% successful meal generation requests
- Less than 5% failed generation attempts

User Satisfaction

- 80% positive feedback on generated meal plans
- Average user satisfaction score of 4/5 or higher

Risks & Limitations

Every product faces uncertainty during development and growth. Understanding these risks early allows PlateUp to proactively prepare mitigation strategies and make better product decisions.

While PlateUp addresses a genuine market problem, several factors could affect adoption, user satisfaction, and long-term success.

Product Risks

AI Recommendation Quality

PlateUp's core value proposition depends heavily on the quality of AI-generated meal plans.

If recommendations are repetitive, unrealistic, culturally inappropriate, or fail to align with user budgets, users may lose trust in the platform.

Potential Impact

- Low user satisfaction
- Reduced retention
- Negative word-of-mouth
- Lower adoption rates

Mitigation Strategy

- Continuously refine AI prompts
- Conduct extensive testing with Nigerian meal scenarios
- Collect user feedback
- Monitor common recommendation failures
- Regularly improve recommendation logic

Budget Accuracy Challenges

Food prices in Nigeria fluctuate frequently due to inflation, seasonal availability, transportation costs, and regional market differences.

As a result, a meal plan that appears affordable today may not reflect real-world pricing tomorrow.

Potential Impact

- User frustration
- Reduced trust in recommendations
- Perceived inaccuracy

Mitigation Strategy

PlateUp should position itself as a budgeting assistant rather than a real-time market pricing platform during the MVP phase.

Future versions can introduce market-price intelligence to improve accuracy.

Ingredient Availability Variations

Nigeria is a geographically diverse country.

Ingredients commonly available in Lagos may not be as accessible or affordable in other states.

Potential Impact

- Recommendations may feel irrelevant to some users
- Reduced satisfaction in certain regions

Mitigation Strategy

Future versions should leverage location data collected during onboarding to improve recommendation relevance.

User Adoption Risks

Resistance to AI-Powered Planning

While AI adoption is growing, some users may still prefer traditional methods of meal planning.

Many households rely heavily on family recommendations and established routines.

Potential Impact

- Slower adoption
- Lower engagement

Mitigation Strategy

Focus on simplicity, ease of use, and practical recommendations.

Users should quickly see value within their first meal plan generation experience.

Low Retention

Some users may generate a meal plan once and never return.

This is a common challenge for productivity applications.

Potential Impact

- Reduced long-term growth
- Lower user lifetime value

Mitigation Strategy

Features such as:

- Meal History
- Saved Plans
- Plan Reuse

are specifically designed to encourage repeat usage.

Competitive Risks

Existing Global Solutions

Large meal-planning platforms already exist and possess:

- Established brands

- Existing user bases
- Significant resources

Potential Impact

Difficulty acquiring users.

Mitigation Strategy

PlateUp should focus on its strongest differentiator:

Nigerian-first meal planning.

General-Purpose AI Tools

Users can already generate meal plans using platforms such as ChatGPT.

Potential Impact

Some users may question the need for a dedicated platform.

Mitigation Strategy

PlateUp provides:

- Structured workflows
- Meal History
- Shopping Lists
- Saved Plans
- Reuse Functionality

These features create a more complete experience than general-purpose AI tools.

Technical Risks

AI Service Availability

PlateUp depends on external AI infrastructure.

Any disruption to AI services could temporarily affect meal generation.

Mitigation Strategy

Implement graceful error handling and monitoring.

Email Delivery Issues

Verification and password-reset emails are critical to the onboarding process.

Delivery failures could prevent users from accessing the platform.

Mitigation Strategy

Using both Resend and Nodemailer provides additional reliability.

MVP Limitations

The MVP intentionally excludes several features.

This is not because these features lack value, but because they are not essential to validating the core product.

Out of Scope

- Subscription billing
- Advanced nutrition dashboard
- Market price comparison
- Family accounts
- Native mobile applications
- Meal customization
- Editing saved meal plans
- Calendar scheduling
- Grocery delivery integrations

The MVP remains focused on solving one core problem exceptionally well:

PlateUp's MVP is built around the following assumptions:

- Nigerians struggle with meal planning and food budgeting.
- Users are willing to trust AI-generated meal recommendations.
- Budget-aware meal planning provides meaningful value.
- Users will save and reuse successful meal plans.
- Nigerian-focused recommendations provide differentiation from general-purpose AI tools.

The MVP will validate whether these assumptions are true before additional features are developed.

Competitive Landscape

Market Overview

The meal-planning market continues to grow as consumers seek convenient, personalized, and budgetconscious ways to manage food decisions. While several meal-planning platforms exist, most are designed for international audiences and do not adequately address the needs of Nigerian households.

PlateUp differentiates itself through Nigerian-focused meal recommendations, Naira-based budgeting, ingredient utilization, shopping list generation, and meal history.

Primary Competitors

Mealime

Mealime is one of the most popular meal-planning applications globally. It allows users to generate meal plans and shopping lists through a simple and user-friendly interface.

Strengths

- Easy-to-use experience
- Strong shopping-list functionality
- Established user base

Limitations

- Primarily focused on Western audiences
- No Nigerian meal focus
- No Naira-based budgeting
- Limited relevance for local ingredient availability

Eat This Much

Eat This Much automatically generates meal plans based on nutritional goals and dietary requirements.

Strengths

- Automated meal planning
- Strong nutrition-focused recommendations
- Personalized meal generation

Limitations

- Primarily nutrition-focused rather than budget-focused
- Not optimized for Nigerian cuisine
- Can feel complex for everyday meal planning

ChatGPT

Many users already use AI tools such as ChatGPT to generate meal recommendations and shopping lists.

Strengths

- Flexible and widely accessible
- Can generate meal ideas instantly
- Supports custom prompts

Limitations

- No meal history
- No saved meal plans
- No reuse functionality
- No structured shopping-list workflow
- No dedicated meal-planning experience

Other Competitors

Competitor	Primary Focus	Key Limitation
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Paprika Recipe Manager	Recipe organization and planning	No AI meal generation or budget awareness
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Plan to Eat	Meal planning and grocery lists	No Nigerian focus or AI recommendations
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YouTube	Meal inspiration and recipes	Not personalized or budget-aware
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Family & WhatsApp Recommendations	Informal meal suggestions	Inconsistent and difficult to organize
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Manual Planning	Personal meal planning	Time-consuming and difficult to maintain
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Market Gap

Despite the availability of meal-planning tools, there is currently no widely adopted AI-powered mealplanning platform focused specifically on Nigerian households.

Most alternatives either focus on Western audiences, nutrition tracking, recipe management, or generalpurpose AI assistance.

PlateUp addresses this gap by combining:

- Nigerian meal recommendations
- Budget-aware planning
- Ingredient optimization
- Shopping list generation
- Meal history and reuse functionality

This positions PlateUp as a specialized solution built for the realities of Nigerian households.

Conclusion

PlateUp is an AI-powered meal planning platform designed specifically for Nigerian households. By combining budget-aware planning, ingredient optimization, shopping list generation, and meal history,

Nigerians face a combination of meal-planning stress, food waste, rising food costs, and a lack of locally relevant planning tools. Existing solutions are either manual, fragmented, or designed for international audiences.

PlateUp addresses these challenges by providing a Nigerian-first AI meal planning assistant that helps users generate practical meal plans, stay within budget, reduce waste, and reuse successful plans over time.